

August 20, 2026

UnitedHealthcare
Provider Appeals
P.O. Box 30432
Salt Lake City, UT 84130

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — José María Casares (MRN MUSC0298996), Claim MUSC-9913-1

Patient	José María Casares (DOB 1974-07-05)
MRN	MUSC0298996
Member ID / Group	UHC137146189 / GRP-40219
Claim number	MUSC-9913-1
Date of service	2026-05-12
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$814.50
Denial code	CARC 197 / RARC N54 — Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent.
Appeal deadline	2027-06-20

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient José María Casares (MRN: MUSC0298996, Member ID: UHC137146189, Group: GRP-40219) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-9913-1 for services rendered on May 12, 2026, by Priya N. Raghavan, MD (NPI 1669504132) at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was denied on June 20, 2026, under CARC 197 ("Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent") and RARC N54 ("Claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified/authorized services"), with the payer remark stating: "No prior authorization on file for the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully contends that prior authorization was not required for the services as billed, and that the denial should be reversed with payment issued at the contracted allowed amount of \$575.54.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Casares is a 52-year-old male with active diagnoses of obesity (E66.9) and longstanding hypertension (I10, onset 1992), for which he has been maintained on Hydrochlorothiazide 25 mg. On May 12, 2026, he presented as an established patient at MUSC Health University Medical Center (Place of Service 22, On Campus Outpatient Hospital) and was evaluated by Dr. Raghavan. The visit was coded as CPT 99214, an office and outpatient evaluation and management service for an established patient reflecting moderate medical decision-making, with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), and a secondary diagnosis of obesity (E66.9). Two units of CPT 99214 were submitted under revenue code 0510, with a total billed charge of \$814.50.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial rests solely on the assertion that no prior authorization was on file for the date of service. MUSC Health respectfully disputes the applicability of a prior authorization requirement to this encounter. CPT 99214 is a standard outpatient evaluation and management service for an established patient. Under widely accepted utilization management principles and consistent with guidance from the American Medical Association and CMS, routine evaluation and management visits — particularly those addressing acute, self-limiting conditions such as an upper respiratory infection in an established patient — are generally not subject to prior authorization requirements. UnitedHealthcare's own clinical and administrative policies for the UnitedHealthcare Choice Plus plan (coverage period 2024–2026) should be reviewed to confirm whether CPT 99214 rendered in an outpatient hospital setting for an established patient with these diagnoses is, in fact, a service requiring advance authorization.

Furthermore, RARC N54 indicates that claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified or authorized services, which implies that some authorization record may exist but does not align with what was billed. MUSC Health requests that UnitedHealthcare conduct a thorough review of any authorization records associated with Member ID UHC137146189 for the May 12, 2026 date of service to ensure no applicable authorization was overlooked or mismatched due to a clerical or system discrepancy. If an authorization gap is confirmed, MUSC Health requests that UnitedHealthcare apply any applicable retrospective review process, as the services rendered were medically necessary and consistent with the patient's documented clinical needs.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that UnitedHealthcare overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-9913-1 and reprocess the claim for payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$575.54. In the alternative, if UnitedHealthcare maintains that prior authorization was required, MUSC Health requests that a retrospective authorization review be initiated and that the claim be adjudicated upon completion of that review. Should additional clinical documentation be required to support this appeal, MUSC Health will provide it promptly upon request. This appeal is submitted within the applicable appeal deadline of June 20, 2027, via the UnitedHealthcare provider portal in accordance with the electronic reconsideration requirements for this plan.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record